

What's left to build, and how it fits together

A build plan for the seven gaps still open in the HR Portal – the four left half-finished inside the five modules already shipped, plus the three modules dropped from scope earlier and now back in. Every step below is checked against the current codebase, not assumed.

Status Planning only – no code written **Scope** HR · Employee · Founder **Prepared** 29 Aug 2026

Updated 29 Aug 2026 – Payroll decision resolved against the real Zoho tool

- Already exists – reuse
- New build
- Decision needed first
- Resolved this round

PART 1 – FINISHING THE FIVE SHIPPED MODULES

01 Document Template — Approval Workflow

Documents upload and go live immediately today. The original spec routes them through an approver first, with the Founder copied on every decision.

- 1 Decide the approval model: does `Payel Ma'am` vs `Soma Ma'am` need to be two specific people, or is "anyone with the HR role" close enough? The app currently only models roles, not named individuals. Decide first
- 2 Reuse the existing `approvals` collection and its Tickets workflow – add a new category, `'document'`, instead of building a parallel system. Reuse
- 3 On upload, create a pending approval record instead of finalizing the document immediately; route project-related documents to Production/Ratish, general ones to HR. New
- 4 On every decision, notify the Founder – reuse the existing `mailer.js` SMTP pipeline already wired for ticket notifications. Reuse
- 5 Directory's document list gets a "Pending approval" state, and HR/Founder get an approval queue (the existing Approval Center view already renders exactly this shape of data). Reuse
- 6 Add a free-text `remarks` field per document, notifying the Founder the same way as a decision. New

02 Leave — Reason, Date Range, Policy Document

Today's Leave option is a same-day, no-reason toggle on the Check-in widget. The original spec asked for a real request: a date range and a reason, plus a Leave Policy document employees can actually read.

- 1 Decide whether to keep the light self-declare model (extended) or introduce a proper `leave_requests` record – the date-range + reason ask fits the latter more naturally. Decide first
- 2 Extend the Leave action into a small form – From date, To date, Reason – instead of a single dropdown option. New
- 3 Backend: accept the range and write one attendance row per day (keeps the existing "count Leave-status rows" balance math working untouched) or a spanning record, per the decision in step 1. New
- 4 Leave Policy document: add it as an 11th entry in the existing Document Template list – no new plumbing, it's the same upload/view infrastructure already built. Reuse

03 Founder's Own View

Founder was named as one of the three scoped surfaces, but none of the five modules currently show up on the Founder dashboard – everything lives only in HR's Directory.

- 1 Decide the shape: a full mirror of HR's Directory, or a lighter read-only rollup (headcounts, pending approvals, performance summary). Decide first
- 2 If a mirror: add a Founder nav entry to the same Directory-style page – the data layer already grants `founder` read access, only the route/UI needs opening up. Reuse
- 3 If a rollup: new dashboard cards – org-wide leave-taken, pending document approvals, performance-by-department – built once the shape is settled. New

04 Employee's Own Leave & Performance

The Employee Portal only has the Check-in widget today. Leave balance and performance numbers currently exist only inside HR's Directory – an employee can't see their own.

- 1 Add self-scoped endpoints – mirroring the existing `attendance/me/today` pattern – so an employee can read their own leave count and performance entries without HR's broader read access. New
- 2 Extract the Leave and Performance display logic already built in `Directory.jsx` into a shared component, so the Employee Portal reuses the same cards instead of rebuilding them. Reuse
- 3 Add "My Leave" and "My Performance" to the Employee dashboard's tab bar. New

PART 2 – MODULES DROPPED EARLIER, NOW BACK IN SCOPE

05 Extra Hours Logging

Nothing exists for this yet – a full new module.

- 1 New `extra_hours` collection: `employeeId`, `projectCode`, `hours`, `date`, `time`, `teammates[]`, `status`. New
- 2 Employee-side submit form on the Employee Portal. New
- 3 Decide the two-step approval: literally Payel-then-Soma as named people, or HR-role-then-Founder-role in sequence. Decide first
- 4 Reuse the `approvals` collection again (category `'extra-hours'`) rather than building a separate approval engine. Reuse
- 5 Show a running extra-hours total on the Employee Profile in Directory. New

06 System / Technical

Better news here: default working hours and the company holiday list already exist end-to-end in Super Admin Settings (`workingHoursStart/End`, `holidays[ ]`) and are already readable by any logged-in user. Only "system remarks" is genuinely unbuilt.

- 1 Add a read-only "Holidays" view inside HR/Employee – it can call the existing `getSystemSettings()` endpoint directly, no new backend. Reuse
- 2 Flag late check-ins on the Attendance page by comparing `checkIn` against `workingHoursStart` – a small UI change over data that already exists. Reuse
- 3 Decide where "system remarks" actually attaches – a specific employee record, or a general log – before scoping its build. Decide first

07 Salary Slip / Payroll

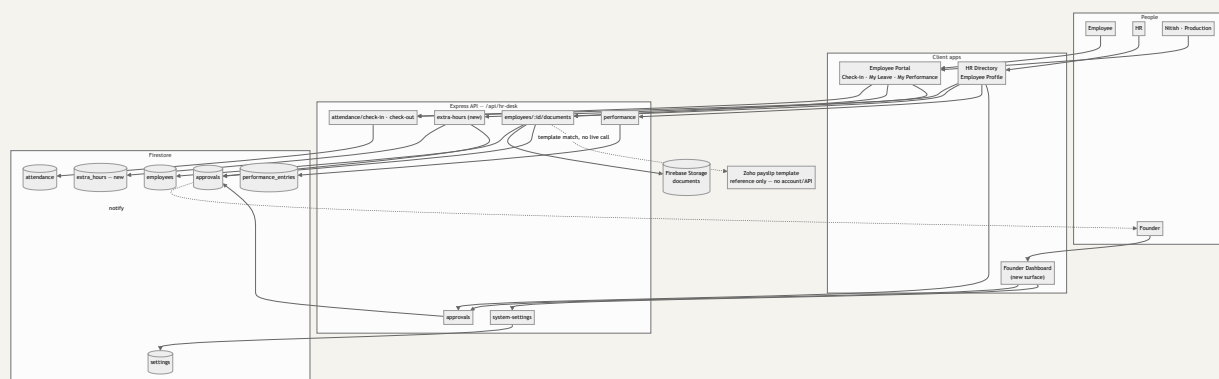
Nothing built yet, but the open decision from the earlier plan is now resolved: [Zoho's free payslip generator](#) – the actual tool the original notes pointed at – turns out to be a no-login, no-API browser form. There's no account or API to integrate with; it's a template to match, not a service to call.

- 1 Resolved – build in-house. Confirmed directly against Zoho's tool: it stores nothing, requires no sign-in, and exposes no API, so "integration" isn't actually on the table here. Resolved
- 2 Field spec, taken from the real tool: Company (name, logo, address) · Employee (name, ID, designation, PAN, bank account, `UAN`) · Pay period (period, year, paid days, LOP days, payment date) · custom Earnings + Deductions line items · computed Gross / Total Deductions / Net Payable · amount in words. Confirmed
- 3 Employee Details already covers most of this (PAN, bank account, designation, Emp Code) – only `UAN` is a genuinely new field to add. New (small)
- 4 Build the payslip template matching that exact structure, populated from the employee's `salary` field plus that period's attendance (paid days / LOP from check-in records). New
- 5 Add a "Generate Payslip" action + PDF download to the Employee Profile. New

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

How the seven gaps plug into what's already running

Solid arrows are data already flowing today; the two collections marked "new" (extra_hours, and a Founder-facing surface) are the only additions to the shape of the system – everything else routes through the same Express API and the same approvals/Storage pattern already in production.



Solid line – data flow live today **Dotted line** – new notification / optional integration

(new) – the only additions to the data model

Grounded against the current codebase on 29 Aug 2026 – every "already exists" claim above was verified in the actual files, not assumed. No code was written or changed in producing this plan.